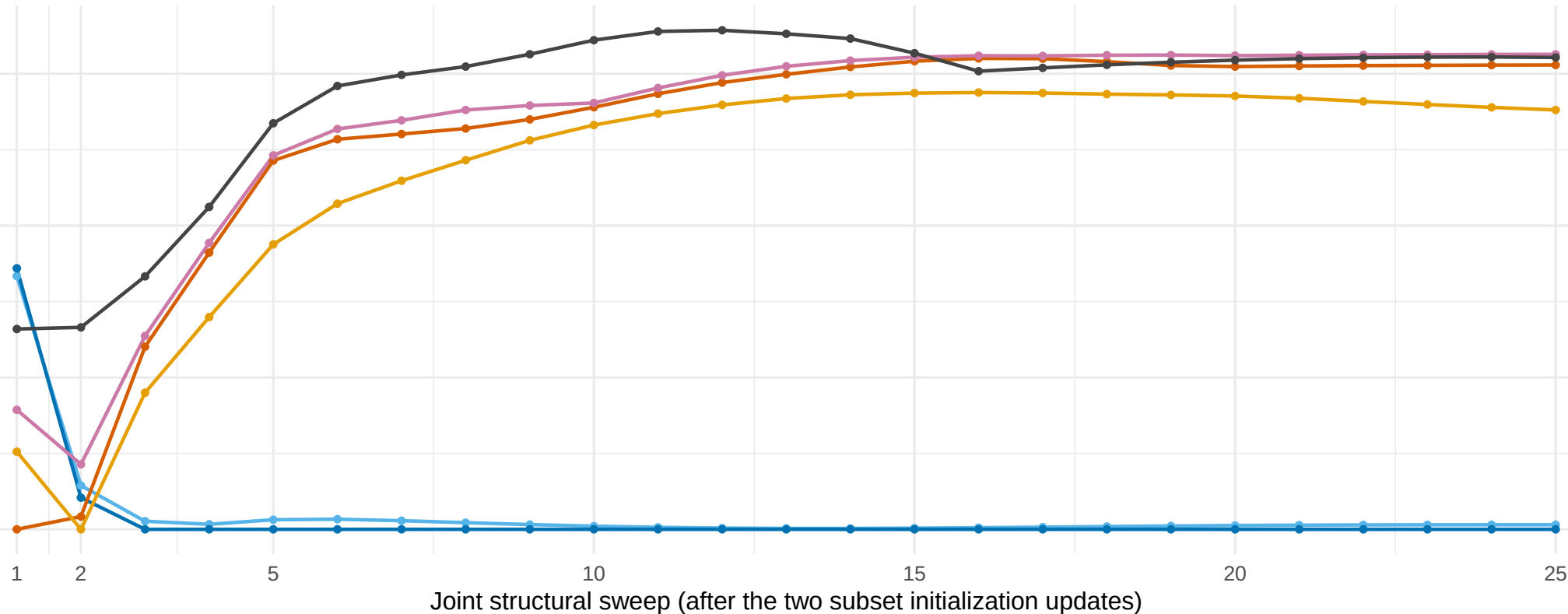


The first-step ELBO selects a different Isomap neighborhood

Original M=5, SNR=4 observations; smaller gap is better. Every state is scored with the ordinary T=1 ELBO.

ELBO gap to the best candidate at the same sweep



Initialization

- k=5
- k=10
- k=15
- k=20
- k=30
- PCA

The fitting path keeps its original T=5 to 1 annealing schedule; only evaluation uses T=1.
These are paired starts on one selected dataset, not an independent validation of a screening rule.